

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-IV

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. There are THIRTEEN questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. Questions 1-5 contain two 10-mark parts. Questions 6-7 carry 10 marks each.
3. Questions 8-12 are 20-mark case studies; Question 13 is a 30-mark case study.
4. Use ethical concepts, stakeholder analysis, options, reasons and safeguards.

Q1. (a) "Values are inculcated, not instructed." Explain the mechanisms through which family, society and educational institutions actually transmit values, and identify the failure mode of each. (b) Examine the proposition that the Fundamental Duties in Article 51A are an effective instrument for inculcating values in Indian citizens.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q2. (a) "The current internet expansion has instilled a different set of cultural values which are often in conflict with traditional values." Discuss. (b) Compare Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana and Basava's Kayaka as frameworks for dignified welfare delivery.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q3. (a) "An unexamined life is not worth living." - Socrates. What does this quotation mean to you? (b) 'Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment but a product of civil education and adherence of the rule of law.' Examine the significance of constitutional morality for a public servant, highlighting its role in promoting good governance and ensuring accountability in public administration.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q4. (a) "Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have the right to do and what is right to do." - Potter Stewart. What does this quotation mean to you? (b) 'In Indian culture and value system, an equal opportunity has been provided irrespective of gender identity. The number of women in public service has been steadily increasing over the years.' Examine the gender-specific challenges faced by female public servants and suggest suitable measures to increase their efficiency in discharging their duties and maintaining high standards of probity.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q5. (a) "The greatest discovery of my generation is that a human being can alter his life by altering his attitudes." - William James. What does this quotation convey to you in the present context? (b) Distinguish irregularity, waste, fraud, abuse of discretion and corruption in the utilisation of public funds.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q6. Distinguish hard-threshold checks from weighted checks in ethical case analysis.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q7. Explain why integrity is described as the hardest foundational value to test at recruitment. What institutional mechanisms serve as continuous proxies?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q8. An honest Municipal Commissioner investigates a fatal mall collapse and finds poor material, unauthorised construction, inspection failures and a prima facie official-builder nexus. Colleagues press for delay, the influential builder offers a bribe, and a threatened POSH complaint is used to demand silence. Discuss the ethical issues, options and selected course of action. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q9. Ramesh, a State Civil Services officer in a border State, submits a confidential report on illegal migrant infiltration and forged documents. A superior orders withdrawal and threatens loss of his capital posting and promotion. Examine his options, preferred course, ethical dilemmas and relevant policy measures. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q10. A public-sector executive receives documents and a video suggesting that the corporation's chairman demanded a bribe connected with a large tyre order and accelerated pending bills. What should the executive do and which ethical and legal concerns arise? Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q11. A department discovers that senior officials split hospitality benefits among family members, use private messaging for official directions and punish junior officers who seek ethics advice. Propose a complete institutional response. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q12. Sneha chairs a hospital procurement process in which her financially stressed brother is a bidder, while management says it will support whatever decision she takes. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q13. A big corporate house is engaged in manufacturing industrial chemicals on a large scale. It proposes to set up an additional unit. Many States rejected its proposal due to detrimental effect on the environment. But one State government acceded to the request and permitted the unit close to a city, brushing aside all opposition. The unit was set up 10 years ago and was in full swing till recently. The pollution caused by the industrial effluents was affecting the land, water and crops in the area. It was also causing serious health problems to human beings and animals. This gave rise to a series of agitations demanding the closure of the plant. In a recent agitation thousands of people took part, creating a law and order problem necessitating stern police action. Following the public outcry, the State government ordered the closure of the factory. The closure of the factory resulted in the unemployment of not only those workers who were engaged in the factory but also those who were working in the ancillary units. It also very badly affected those industries which depended on the chemicals manufactured by it. As a senior officer entrusted with the responsibility of handling this issue, how are you going to address it?

[30 marks | 350 words]

END OF PAPER